Beat That!

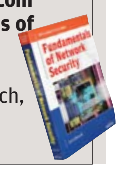
Photograph **Jiten Gandhi**

Every month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15th of this month.

Digit Caption
'You shoot me, I shoot you!'

Last Month's Winner!
G.S.Sahota,
Qr.No.AP-11,Atlanta Point,
Port Blair, Andaman & Nicobar
Islands-744102
'*Greasing Communications*'

E-mail your caption with the subject 'Beat That', and your postal address, to **beatthat@thinkdigit.com** and win **Fundamentals of Network Security** by Eric Maiwald
Published by Dreamtech, New Delhi



Formally, the 672 and the 662 will feature Intel Virtualization Technology. They are priced at $605 (Rs 27,000) and $401 (Rs 17,500) respectively, in 1,000-unit quantities.

Virtualisation will be extremely beneficial in a business setting, where the system administration can carry on with their maintenance duties without interfering with any workers' PC use. Virtualisation could also isolate virus attacks to only the setting in which the attack takes place—this will ensure that the virus will not spread and infect the entire system or even a network.

The virtualisation concept and technology are themselves not new. Several software-based virtualisation solutions already exist in the market. However, when implemented in the hardware, virtualisation could become more efficient in terms of space and speed.

Computer makers such as Acer and Lenovo, will be the first to offer PCs with the new Pentium IVs. More manufacturers are expected to begin selling machines with the chips in early 2006.

With virtualisation in desktop computer chips, Intel can claim an area where it's beaten AMD. Intel had a big setback earlier this year when they lost the race for coming out with the first dual-core processor for servers. In this respect, Intel was over six months behind AMD. With the current pace of developments, Intel will make virtualisation available for its Itanium and Xeon server processors as well as the Pentium M chip for laptops by next summer. Intel also plans to introduce these in dual-core Pentium processors for desktop computers by mid 2006.

Intel is making virtualisation technology available now, even though software makers have not yet introduced operating systems that can take advantage of the technology. Intel expects the software to be available by the middle of next year. However, analysts are of the opinion that these software may be available as early as January 2006.

EFFICIENT MULTICORE

A New 8-Core Chip

Is this the rise of a new Sun? Well, Sun Microsystems surely hopes it is. The company has just launched a new processor aimed at the server market. The Ultra Sparc T1 chip, code-named Niagara, promises to be more than just a chip off the old, umm, chips! Powered by eight cores on a single chip, the T1 at 70 watts consumes less than half the power required to run similar processors.